



M O N D A Y

JOY:

A FRUIT OF LOVE

“But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control; against such things there is no law.”

Galatians 5:22, 23

Let's learn about fruit from around the World:

KIWI

Kiwi fruit has light brown skin with an oval-like shape. Kiwi can be eaten raw, turned into a juice, added to baked goods, or used to season and garnish food dishes. The kiwi fruit was first found growing in China. At the beginning of the twentieth century, missionaries brought the fruit to the island of New Zealand, where it received its name “kiwi” after the small flightless bird native to the island.

Although Kiwi fruit is native to China and New Zealand, it can be grown anywhere the climate is consistently warm. They love sunshine and grow best against a sunny wall. Eating two kiwi fruits an hour before bedtime will help you fall asleep quicker, sleep more soundly, and feel better rested when you wake up in the morning.

TODAY'S SPIRITUAL FRUIT IS

JOY

Galatians 5:22 and 23 recites: “But the fruit of the Spirit is love, **joy**, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control; against such things there is no law.”

Close your eyes and think of a time when something filled you with joy. Perhaps it was seeing a loved one after not seeing them for a while or eating your favorite ice cream or receiving a surprise bouquet of balloons or flowers and it wasn't even your birthday. Maybe you received a promotion at work, or it was the birth or adoption of your child? Do you feel the flood of happy emotions filling your soul right now?

Dictionary.com defines joy as: “the emotion of great delight or happiness caused by something exceptionally good or satisfying; keen pleasure; elation.” Another definition offered is: “a source or cause of keen pleasure or delight, something or someone greatly valued or appreciated.”

These definitions of joy are simply delightful and wonderful. Yet, what makes the joy that comes from having Jesus in your heart an exceptional and unique experience is that it goes beyond the moment. To be sure, this kind of joy stays with us regardless of what someone may or may not do for us. This joy is not on the surface only; rather, one that remains with us because we are filled with the Spirit of Christ.

This is the kind of joy Jesus was referring to when He said to the disciples, “These things I have spoken to you so that My joy may be in you, and that your joy may be made full” (Jn 15:11). It is a joy

that is embedded deep within us so that we can brighten a room with a joyful attitude. We can make others happy to be around us and our attitude gives hope to others. Despite what challenges we are experiencing, our lives are filled with joy, and we can be positive and filled with encouragement for ourselves and for others.

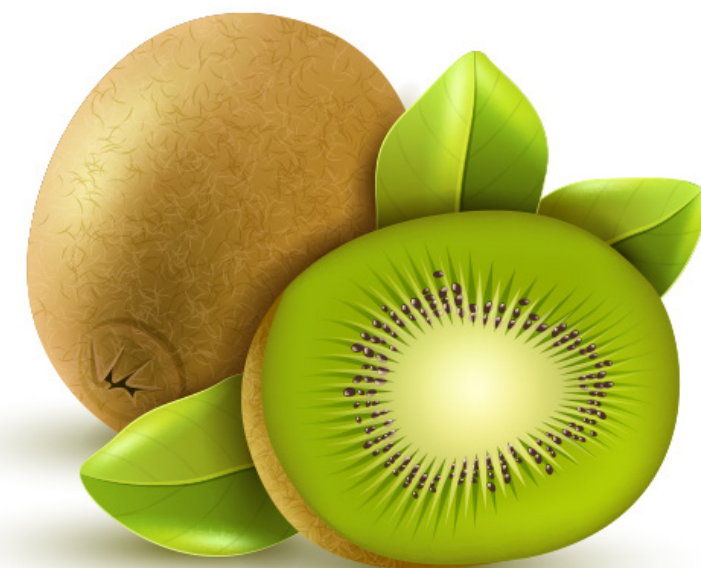
Many studies today show that laughter and positive emotions decrease pain and can reduce anxiety. Mental health experts say if you are feeling stressed, schedule a little time for joyful and fun activities, it will boost your ability to bounce back from stress, fight disease, solve problems and think flexibly. The wiseman Solomon tells us: “A joyful heart is good medicine, but a broken spirit dries up the bones” (Prov 17:22).

Ellen White shares godly counsel about how to develop and keep an attitude of joy when she offers: “The home may be plain, but it can always be a place where cheerful words are spoken and kindly deeds are done, where courtesy and love are abiding guests... Wherever the love of God is cherished in the soul, there will be peace, there will be light and joy.” (*The Adventist Home*, pp. 18, 19).

Choose the fruit of joy in your family today. Sing songs of gladness and worship as you allow the Spirit of God to fill your hearts with His everlasting joy, helping to create a space where angels love to dwell.

PRAY:

Dear God, how great it is to know that you care so much about us. It makes us leap for joy! Help us appreciate the daily blessings that you provide and find joy in every situation. In Jesus' name, amen.



FRUITFUL **JOY** ACTIVITY

You will need:

- Paper and drawing materials (optional)

Instructions:

- Encourage everyone in your group or family think about a time when they feel happy and joyful.
- Then ask each person to mime (act out without words) the time when they feel joyful for the rest of the family to guess.
- Enjoy doing this funny activity together
- Alternatively, everyone can write or draw something that helps them to feel joyful.
- Talk about the happiest things that happened in the last week and thank God for them.

QUESTIONS TO TALK ABOUT TOGETHER

- Being joyful is a fruit of the Spirit because...
- Jesus showed joy when...
- Other Bible characters who showed joy were...
- When I am sad it really helps me when others...
- Some things that make me feel joyful are...
- I was joyful this week when...
- We can experience more joy in our family by...
- We can share joy with others by...
- Pray: Thank You, God, that we experienced joy this week when...

BIBLE VERSE ACTIVITY

You will need:

- A foam ball, balloon, or other soft and light object that you can throw to each other
- Strong inflatable balloons - yellow balloons with smiley faces if you can find them (or cut balloon shapes out of paper or cardstock)
- Permanent marker pens if you are using balloons, or other pens if you are writing on cardstock or paper

Instructions:

- Practice saying the Bible verse together. Or sing it together.
- Then stand in a circle with the ball or balloon. The person holding the ball says the first word of the verse and then throws the ball to any other person. The person who catches the ball says the second word in the verse, before throwing it to another person who says the third word, etc.
- Continue until you have completed the verse and the reference. Repeat the activity trying to complete the verse faster each time.
- Then search your Bibles for other verses about joy. Use permanent marker pens to write these joy verses on the balloons, and then hang them up in your home.
- Or write the joy verses on your cut-out balloons instead.

